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Inn

3.3 Inn

References:

Hebrew אֹרְחִים, מָלוֹן (malon ’orchim) JER 9:1

Greek κατάλυμα (kataluma) LUK 2:7, SIR 14:25, 1MA 3:45, ODA 1:13

Greek πανδοχεῖον (pandocheion) LUK 10:34

Greek πανδοχεύς (pandocheus (“innkeeper”)) LUK 10:35

Greek ταβέρνη (tabernē) ACT 28:15

Description and usage:

The inn was a place for the lodging of travelers. Meals were also served. Unlike some modern bars and hotels, it did not have particular associations with alcohol or prostitution.

Translation:

In some languages it may be necessary to describe the role of an inn as “a place where people could stay overnight and get something to eat” or even “a place where people could pay in order to stay overnight and get something to eat.” Compare NCV ’s rendering of inn in JER 9:1, where it has “a house where travelers spend the night.” It is highly likely this is the only place in the Old Testament where the Hebrew word malon refers to an actual inn or permanent structure for the lodging of travelers.